

The Dhāraṇī of Amitābha

Toh 867 · Derge Kangyur

This short text, which can be rendered in English as the Dhāraṇī of Amitābha, is a brief dhāraṇī dedicated to the Buddha Amitābha, the Buddha of Infinite Light. The Tibetan title lines open with homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Amitābha, and the colophon identifies it as the Recollection of Amitābha. A specific Sanskrit title and Tibetan title are not clearly given in the lines available here, so they are best described generally rather than stated with precision. The text consists of an homage, the dhāraṇī itself, beginning with the words "amite, amitodbhave," and a short statement of its benefits, which promises that reciting it purifies grave karmic obscurations and the downfalls of the root vows, and plants roots of virtue under many buddhas. It is Toh 867 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the short mantric formulas of protection and merit gathered among the tantra and dhāraṇī sections of the collection.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Amitābha, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha.

Tadyathā: amite, amitodbhave, amitasamḥhave, amitavikrāntagāmini, gaganakīrtikare, sarvakleśakṣayaṃkari svāhā.

These are the benefits of this dhāraṇī. It should be understood that even karmic obscurations accumulated over a hundred thousand eons are exhausted when it is recited three times. If it is recited twenty-one times, the negativity of the four root downfalls is completely purified, and one also comes to have planted roots of virtue under a thousand buddhas.

The Recollection of Amitābha is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The Tibetan here reads Snang ba mtha' yas, "Infinite Light," which is a standard rendering of Amitābha. The mantra is given in its standard Sanskrit form. The Tibetan transcription is slightly irregular: it reads "sarba kāe śa" for sarvakleśa and "vikrānta" for vikrānta. The "four root downfalls" are the four defeats (pārājika) of the monastic code.

Colophon

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texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.